Worked Example: a confusing sign-up journey

This is an invented case to show how to combine the starter tools. It is not a claim about a real organization or a measured outcome.

1 — The observation

Customers trying to make a straightforward purchase are required to create an account, choose a password and re-enter a delivery address. Some users contact support before completing checkout. The team suspects a drop-off problem but has not yet established how much of it is caused by registration.

2 — A recorded friction example

Card field	Illustrative response
User goal	Buy an item without unnecessary delays
Observed friction	Registration is compulsory before the customer can pay
Affected group	First-time customers, especially those struggling with passwords
Evidence status	Hypothesis supported by anecdotal support reports; direct observation needed
Possible fix	Pilot guest checkout; retain clear confirmation and purchase records
Outcome to measure	Checkout success, repeat calls, reported confidence and reversal errors

3 — Map conflicting agendas

- Design wants fewer choices and fewer steps.
- Product management must protect a committed release schedule.
- Engineering highlights dependencies on an old identity service.
- Finance requires an estimate of the pilot cost and a credible benefit.
- Customer support wants fewer repeat contacts and better recovery.

4 — Choose a bounded pilot

Agree to trial guest checkout for a limited journey, with a named Product Owner and technical risk owner. Compare results against an appropriate baseline; include users who rely on assisted channels. Record labor and integration costs instead of claiming a free fix.

5 — Verify, do not celebrate too early

If completion increases but payment disputes, poor comprehension or support calls also increase, the change may have displaced friction rather than removed it. Test what actually happened, review exclusions, and only then extend the pilot.

Use this example as a guide, not as sample research data to present to management.